

Deal 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ K Q J
♣ 5 2

8
7 8
17

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4



♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3

♠ Q
♥ T 6
♦ T 9 4 3 2
♣ A Q T 9 8

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SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise.

Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Deal 2

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A T 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ T 9 7 3
♣ T 3 2

10
8 6
16

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ T 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4



♠ -
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K J 8 4 2
♥ 5
♦ Q 6 5 4
♣ 9 8 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			

6 ♥ by South

, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

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SOUTH has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and NORTH shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one

of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that NORTH holds the

♦

A,

he bids 6

♥

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 8 5
♥ J 7 6 4
♦ T
♣ T 3 2

10
4 5
21

♠ A 7
♥ K 3
♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2
♣ 7 6



♠ K 6 2
♥ A T 9
♦ A K 3
♣ A K 8 4

♠ T 4 3
♥ Q 8 5 2
♦ 6 5
♣ Q J 9 5

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5NT
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			

slam and bids 7NT.

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NORTH isn't sure just how much he can make,
but surely 6

♦

isn't

too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and SOUTH shows
three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and SOUTH shows
three.

Hmm, NORTH can now count all thirteen
tricks, so he forgets about the

♦

Deal 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 7
♥ A T 8 5 4
♦ J 7 6
♣ 4 2

11
5 4
20

♠ J 8
♥ J 7 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q T 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 5 4 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ A T 9 4 2
♣ 3

♠ A K Q
♥ K Q 6
♦ K Q 3
♣ J 8 7 5

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

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NORTH has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it

would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Deal 5

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J T 9 4
♥ A J T 8 2
♦ J 5 4
♣ 2

15
7 3
15

♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 3
♦ K 6
♣ K T 6 5 3



♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 6
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ A Q 7

♠ 8 3 2
♥ 5 4
♦ Q T 7 2
♣ J 9 8 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	4NT		1NT
All Pass			
4NT by South			



Q

were changed to the



A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

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Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17,

but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT.

In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her